

Malcolm Carrara

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

Sterling planned to replace your commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after the opening and dispute your final payment.

What you are hiding

You built one internal support differently from the approved plan because the fabricator missed a deadline. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
- Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.
- Ask at least two people where they were during the poisoning window.

What you know about other guests

- Sterling has been threatening Lucian over the centerpiece installation and final payment.
- Sterling owns a student painting Julian desperately does not want exhibited.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

Calvin and Lucian were with you moving a pedestal during the key window.

IF MURDERER

You entered the salon at 6:43 to demand payment, poisoned the cordial, and left marble dust from your cuff on the service cloth.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card A. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card B. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I changed an internal support in my sculpture because the fabricator missed a deadline. It is sound, but it is not exactly the approved plan. Sterling knew and planned to use that against my final payment. Lucian and the handling log place me elsewhere when the glass was poisoned.

IF MURDERER

Sterling planned to copy my commission, withhold my payment, and call the replica prudence. I confronted him, poisoned the cordial, and carried enough marble dust on my cuff to leave a trace on the glass. I make objects meant to outlive me. Sterling made sure this decision will too.

Investigation notes
